

Preface

I learned about money the hard way. I was happily married, enjoying life to its fullest. We had lots of credit card debt and virtually no savings whatsoever. It didn't concern us since we were young. We had our whole lives ahead of us...or so we thought.

When my husband was diagnosed with a terminal illness, it was the beginning of the most trying time of my life. Not only was I distraught beyond belief over losing my husband, but I was also stressed over losing our house and cars. I kept picturing myself without a husband, a place to live, or transportation. My income and his disability payments were not enough to pay all our bills. Since we didn't have any savings in reserve, I was forced to get a second job at the worst possible time.

Somehow, through the grace of God, I made it through that time without having a nervous breakdown. I now believe that denial was a good thing for me at the time. Years later, I was eventually ready to confront the tragedy emotionally. I think back to that time and I regret that I couldn't spend more time with my husband before he died. If we had only been more financially savvy, I am certain I wouldn't have had to work two jobs. If we had saved some of our money and hadn't had so much debt, I wouldn't have had the added stress about our money troubles. Losing a loved one is enough stress for any one person to handle without also having to worry about how you will pay the bills.

I've always heard that everything happens for a reason. I couldn't fathom what reason could have been behind my husband's death at the age of thirty. I always thought it was a waste, a loss without reason. But if I am to make something